

BUSINESS COMMUNICATION

UNIT 2 — WRITTEN ENGLISH COMMUNICATION

Exam-Ready • Highlighted Notes • BCA

Syllabus: Essay Writing • Precis Writing • Summarising • Paraphrasing

Complete revision notes with formats, methods, examples, common mistakes and important exam questions.

1. Essay Writing

Meaning: An essay is a structured piece of writing in which the writer presents ideas, arguments, information or personal views on a specific topic.

Basic Structure of an Essay

Part	Purpose
Introduction	Introduces the topic, gives context and presents the main idea/thesis.
Body Paragraphs	Develops arguments, explanations, examples and supporting details.
Conclusion	Summarises the main ideas and gives a final observation or judgement.

How to Write a Good Essay

- Understand the topic before writing.
- Plan the main points and their order.
- Write a clear introduction.
- Keep each paragraph focused on one main idea.
- Use relevant examples, facts or illustrations.
- Use linking words such as however, therefore, moreover and in addition.
- End with a concise conclusion.
- Proofread grammar, spelling and punctuation.

Exam Tip

A strong essay should have unity, coherence, clarity, logical order and relevant supporting details.

Common Types of Essays

- **Descriptive:** describes a person, place, object or experience.
- **Narrative:** presents a sequence of events or tells a story.
- **Expository:** explains or informs about a topic.
- **Argumentative:** presents a position supported by reasons and evidence.

Mini Example — Essay Outline

Topic: Importance of Time Management

Introduction: Time is a limited resource and effective management improves productivity.

Body: planning, prioritisation, avoiding procrastination, balancing study and personal activities.

Conclusion: disciplined use of time helps achieve academic and professional goals.

2. Precis Writing

Meaning: A precis is a concise and accurate version of a longer passage that retains its central idea and essential points.

Characteristics of a Good Precis

- Shorter than the original passage.
- Contains the central idea and important supporting points.
- Uses clear and concise language.
- Usually written in your own words.
- Maintains the original meaning and logical order.
- Avoids personal opinions and unnecessary details.

Steps for Precis Writing

1. Read the passage carefully at least twice.
2. Identify the central idea.
3. Underline or note the essential points.
4. Remove examples, repetition, illustrations and minor details where appropriate.
5. Rewrite the ideas in your own concise language.
6. Choose a suitable title.
7. Check that the original meaning has not changed.
8. Revise grammar, tense, pronouns and sentence flow.

Remember

A precis is not a collection of copied sentences. It is a connected, shortened version of the original passage.

Precis Writing — Quick Checklist

Check	Question
Length	Is it sufficiently shorter than the original?
Meaning	Is the original message preserved?
Language	Is it mostly in your own words?
Relevance	Have unnecessary details been removed?
Title	Does the title reflect the central idea?

3. Summarising

Meaning: Summarising means presenting the main ideas of a longer text briefly and clearly while leaving out less important information.

Purpose of Summarising

- Save time for the reader.
- Present the main information quickly.
- Show understanding of a text.
- Make revision and note-making easier.

Method

1. Read and understand the complete text.
2. Find the main idea of each paragraph.
3. Separate essential points from examples and repetition.
4. Group related ideas.
5. Write a connected summary in your own words.
6. Check for accuracy, clarity and unnecessary repetition.

Precis vs Summary

Precis	Summary
A concise version of a passage.	A brief account of the main ideas of a text.
Often follows the original order closely.	May reorganise ideas for clarity when appropriate.
Commonly used as a formal writing exercise.	Widely used in academic, professional and everyday contexts.
Usually focuses on preserving the passage's overall structure and meaning.	Focuses on rephrasing the key information and main message.

4. Paraphrasing

Meaning: Paraphrasing is expressing the meaning of an original statement or passage in different words and sentence structures without changing its essential meaning.

Techniques for Effective Paraphrasing

- Replace suitable words with accurate synonyms.
- Change sentence structure where appropriate.
- Change active voice to passive voice, or vice versa, when meaning remains unchanged.
- Change the order of clauses when it improves clarity.
- Combine or split sentences carefully.
- Keep technical terms and proper names when replacing them would change meaning.
- Always preserve the original idea.

Example

Original	Regular practice improves a student's writing skills.
Paraphrased	A student's ability to write becomes better through consistent practice.

Important Difference

Paraphrasing is not simply changing a few words. The sentence structure and wording should be substantially re-expressed while the original meaning remains accurate.

Paraphrasing vs Summarising

Paraphrasing	Summarising
Usually keeps approximately the same level of detail.	Reduces the text to its key ideas.
Rewrites the original meaning in different language.	Condenses the overall content.
Useful when explaining or restating a particular passage.	Useful when giving a brief overview.

5. Exam-Ready Revision

Term	One-Line Definition
Essay	Structured writing with introduction, body and conclusion.
Precis	Concise version of a passage preserving its central meaning.
Summary	Brief presentation of the main ideas of a longer text.
Paraphrase	Restatement of an idea using different wording and structure without changing meaning.

Important Exam Questions

1. What is essay writing? Explain the structure of a good essay.
2. Discuss the characteristics and steps of effective essay writing.
3. What is precis writing? Explain the steps involved in writing a precis.

4. What are the essential characteristics of a good precis?
5. Define summarising. Explain the process of writing an effective summary.
6. Differentiate between precis writing and summarising.
7. What is paraphrasing? Explain different techniques of paraphrasing.
8. Differentiate between paraphrasing and summarising.
9. Write a short essay on a suitable academic or social topic.
10. Given a passage, prepare a suitable precis/summary and provide an appropriate title.

Last-Minute Exam Strategy

For theory answers: start with a definition, explain the key points in headings, add a short example where useful, and end with a concise conclusion. For writing exercises, follow the required format and proofread before submission.

Based strictly on the syllabus provided: Module II — Written English Communication.